

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp

FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 19, 2025 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVI NO. 68

WSJ.com

★★★★ \$5.00

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What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Several executives at xAI** left after clashing with two of Elon Musk's closest advisers over concern about the startup's management and financial health. **A1**

◆ **Nvidia said it would** invest \$5 billion in Intel shares and form a new product partnership with its rival, the latest step in Intel's efforts to revive its flagging fortunes. **A1**

◆ **Huawei plans to roll out** more AI chips in the next three years, giving a glimpse into its ambitions to compete with Nvidia in China. **B4**

◆ **The Nasdaq, S&P 500 and** the Dow industrials gained 0.9%, 0.5% and 0.3%, respectively, hitting new highs. **B9**

◆ **Meta has held** discussions in recent months with a number of media companies, including Fox and News Corp, about licensing their articles for use in its AI tools. **B1**

◆ **The FTC and seven states** sued Ticketmaster and its parent company Live Nation, alleging that the ticketing giant engaged in illegal ticket resale tactics. **B1**

◆ **The number of** Americans who newly filed for unemployment benefits declined sharply last week. **A2**

◆ **Hyundai lifted** its revenue outlook for the full year and said it plans to ramp up manufacturing in the U.S. **B2**

◆ **FedEx plans to rely** more on shipping within the U.S. and from markets such as Europe, as tariffs slow trade to the U.S. from China. **B4**

◆ **Darden Restaurants** raised its full-year sales outlook but cautioned that higher food and labor costs will hurt earnings in the near term. **B3**

World-Wide

◆ **The Trump administration** is putting the weight of the federal government behind a crackdown on political speech it deems objectionable in the aftermath of the fatal shooting of Charlie Kirk. **A1**

◆ **President Trump's team** is weighing a plan to spur the construction of factories and other infrastructure in a bid to jump-start the American manufacturing sector. **A1**

◆ **The Trump administration** asked the Supreme Court to let it remove Lisa Cook from the Fed's board while a lawsuit challenging Trump's effort to fire her proceeds. **A2**

◆ **Robert F. Kennedy Jr.'s** handpicked slate of vaccine advisers voted to no longer recommend a combined shot for measles, mumps, rubella and varicella for children under age 4. **A4**

◆ **A federal judge in** Washington blocked the Trump administration from deporting unaccompanied Guatemalan minors. **A3**

◆ **More than a dozen** elected officials were arrested while protesting conditions at a New York City immigration holding facility. **A6**

◆ **California policymakers** who had tried to spur a transition away from fossil fuels are now working to entice fuel-makers to stay open. **A3**

◆ **Saudi Arabia signed** a defense pact with Pakistan, the only Muslim-majority country with nuclear weapons. **A16**

◆ **The WHO said** that 31 of 38 confirmed Ebola cases have resulted in deaths in the southern part of the Democratic Republic of Congo. **A16**

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Budget Protests Clog Streets Across France



TOM NICHOLSON/REUTERS

BLOCK PARTY: Demonstrators use megaphones in Paris on Thursday as part of a day of strikes and rallies fueled by anger over potential government budget cuts. Hundreds of thousands took part in the nationwide 'Let's Block Everything' protests. **A16**

Trump Pushes to Silence Opponents

Kimmel suspension is latest effort by administration to go after critics' speech

By NATALIE ANDREWS AND AARON ZITNER

WASHINGTON—The Trump administration is putting the weight of the federal government behind a crackdown on political speech it deems objectionable in the aftermath of the fatal shooting of conservative activist Charlie Kirk.

On Wednesday afternoon, the head of the Federal Communications Commission suggested the agency could punish ABC over comments made by comedian Jimmy Kimmel related to Kirk's killing. By Wednesday evening, Disney, ABC's parent company, said it was taking Kimmel's late-night show off the air indefinitely. Hours later, President Trump said he was labeling antifa—a loose affiliation of far-left activist groups—as “a major terrorist organization.” Earlier this week, Attorney General Pam Bondi raised the

prospect of prosecuting people who engage in hate speech. And behind the scenes, senior administration officials are drawing up plans to take action against left-leaning organizations. Taken together, the moves appear to mark an escalation of Trump's efforts to target his perceived opponents and critics. The president and his team have discussed investigating liberal philanthropist George Soros and left-leaning foundations under the corrupt-organizations law known as RICO. Trump advisers are

also weighing whether to review the tax-exempt status of left-leaning nonprofit groups, administration officials said. On Wednesday, more than 100 foundations and groups, including those that have been named by the administration as potential targets, such as the Ford Foundation and Soros's Open Society Foundations, pushed back, writing in an open letter that “attempts to silence speech, criminalize

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◆ **Disney moved swiftly to punish Jimmy Kimmel...** **A4**

Banks Fight Charges of ‘Debanking’

Conservatives see bias. Financial institutions cite risk and regulatory pressure for closures.

By ALEXANDER SAEEDY AND DYLAN TOKAR

Steve Happ was packing to leave Tennessee for an evangelical mission to Uganda in 2023 when Bank of America told him it was canceling his church's bank account and his credit cards. Happ, an elder at the Servants of Christ Church in Memphis, started to sweat. He had over \$270,000 socked away at Bank of America in three accounts—all getting closed by the bank—including one for his charity that supports churches and

orphanages in Uganda. He had bills due, five full-time employees to pay and money that was supposed to go to the orphanages for food. Happ drove to his bank branch in Memphis, convinced there was a mistake. The letters from the bank said “we have determined you're operating in a business type we have chosen not to service.” Happ showed the letters to the branch manager he had known for years. She assured him that there must have been an error and left to check.

“She came back sort of like a robot,” Happ said. “All she did was quote that very same line from the letters and say, ‘I'm sorry, I can't talk to you about this.’” Happ concluded that Bank of America didn't want to work with Christian groups. In a statement, Bank of America said it respected the work of Happ's charity. It said it closed the accounts “solely because it operated a business outside the U.S. and provided debt collection ser-

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Musk Team Clashed With xAI Executives

By ALEXANDER SAEEDY AND BERBER JIN

Several executives at xAI left after clashing with two of Elon Musk's closest advisers over concern about the startup's management and financial health, according to people familiar with the matter. Those advisers, Jared Birchall and John Hering, oversee the day-to-day operations of xAI while Musk, as chief executive officer, makes final decisions. Some of xAI's executives voiced objections internally over how Birchall and Hering were trying to run the company on Musk's behalf and felt there was no formal chain of command, the people said. Some xAI executives said they left because they were concerned that some of the company's financial projections were unrealistic, the people said. They also raised questions internally about the role Musk's family office, Excession, played in managing some

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SAUL LOEB/AP/GETTY IMAGES

U.S. NEWS
White House asks Supreme Court to let it remove Fed governor while case proceeds. **A2**



ASTRID STANWAZ/GETTY IMAGES

BUSINESS & FINANCE
Amex raises annual fee on its Platinum credit card to \$895, boosts rewards. **B1**

A Politician's Secret Power: He'll Say Anything for \$95

* * *

Britain's Nigel Farage has surged in polls, partly by selling cringey video greetings

By JAMES HOOKWAY

BROXBURN, Scotland—There is something discomfiting about watching Rudy Giuliani perform “I'm a Little Teapot” on camera for a few hundred dollars. Or George Santos, the disgraced congressman, filming wry videos

on demand to mark birthdays or provide pep talks. But British politician Nigel Farage hasn't just mastered the business of selling short video greetings on the Cameo website. He has turned it into one of the main planks in his campaign to become the U.K.'s

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President Weighs Big Role In Factory Revival

Trump team mulls government-backed plan using Japan's \$550 billion fund

By BRIAN SCHWARTZ AND GAVIN BADE

WASHINGTON—President Trump's team is weighing a plan to spur the construction of factories and other infrastructure in a bid to jump-start the U.S.'s manufacturing sector, according to documents and people familiar with the discussions. Under the plan, the administration would use money from a \$550 billion investment fund established as part of trade negotiations with Japan to invest in the development of semiconductors, pharmaceuticals, critical minerals, energy, ships and quantum computing. Some of the projects would be granted preferential treatment from the government, including expedited regulatory review. The administration is considering granting leases to companies that would give them access to federal land and water, according to the people and documents reviewed by The Wall Street Journal. The plan would mark a new frontier in Trump's efforts to exert influence over the pri-

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TOMORROW



WSJ. MAGAZINE

LUKA DONCIC

Nvidia to Invest \$5 Billion in Intel, Form Partnership

Nvidia said it would invest \$5 billion in Intel shares and form a new product partnership with its rival, the latest step in Intel's efforts to revive its flagging fortunes.

By Robbie Whelan, Amrith Ramkumar and Lauren Thomas

The investment pairs the world's most valuable company, which has been a darling of the artificial-intelligence boom, with a chip maker that has almost completely fallen out of the AI conversation. Under the terms of the deal, Intel will design custom CPUs—central processing units, the computer brains that power devices from smartphones and laptops to automobiles—that will be easily integrated with Nvidia's chips and other equipment in both data centers and personal computers. Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang called the partnership “historic” in a conference call

Thursday. His company goes head-to-head with Intel on designing chips, but in recent years has taken an enormous lead because of Huang's savvy bet on AI processors. Intel is the only major U.S. company that both designs and fabricates the most powerful chips, such as those used for advanced AI computing. “We're taking the next great step,” Huang said. “We're essentially going to be a major customer of Intel's server CPUs. This is the first time.” Thursday's agreement is a victory for Intel Chief Executive Lip-Bu Tan, who is in the middle of a high-wire turnaround effort backed by the Trump administration. At the heart of the deal is a product that is one of the few areas where Intel remains dominant: CPUs based on a chip architecture known as X86. Intel and rival Advanced Micro Devices are the two

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◆ **Huawei unveils new AI chip pipeline.**..... **B4**